4. Practical Part (study, research, analysis and developing solutions)

The practical component of this thesis serves to examine the empirical realities of Indian student mobility to the Czech Republic through a rigorous statistical analysis of primary survey data collected from 178 respondents. This analysis is fundamentally anchored in Self-Determination Theory (SDT), which posits that human motivation is driven by the fulfillment of three basic psychological needs: autonomy, competence, and relatedness.[1] By categorizing the survey responses into intrinsic and extrinsic/pragmatic motivational clusters, it is possible to discern the underlying psychological mechanisms that influence destination choice and the subsequent satisfaction of Indian students within the Czech higher education landscape. This chapter systematically details the demographic profile of the participants, assesses institutional reputation via global rankings, and evaluates the relative weight of academic, financial, and social factors through mean score calculations and independent samples T-tests.

The integration of QS World University Rankings 2026 data reveals that 19 Czech universities appear in global rankings, with Charles University leading at rank 265, followed by Czech Technical University in Prague (416) and Masaryk University (430). The International Student Ratio (ISR) analysis demonstrates varying levels of internationalization across Czech institutions, with implications for student perceptions of academic quality and global recognition. This chapter synthesizes these findings to provide actionable insights for Czech universities, policymakers, and prospective international students.

Furthermore, this empirical analysis directly addresses the four core research objectives outlined in the methodology, specifically evaluating economic pull factors, psychological drivers, lived experiences, and the association of demographic variables with motivational priorities.

4.1 Demographic Profiling and Sample Characteristics

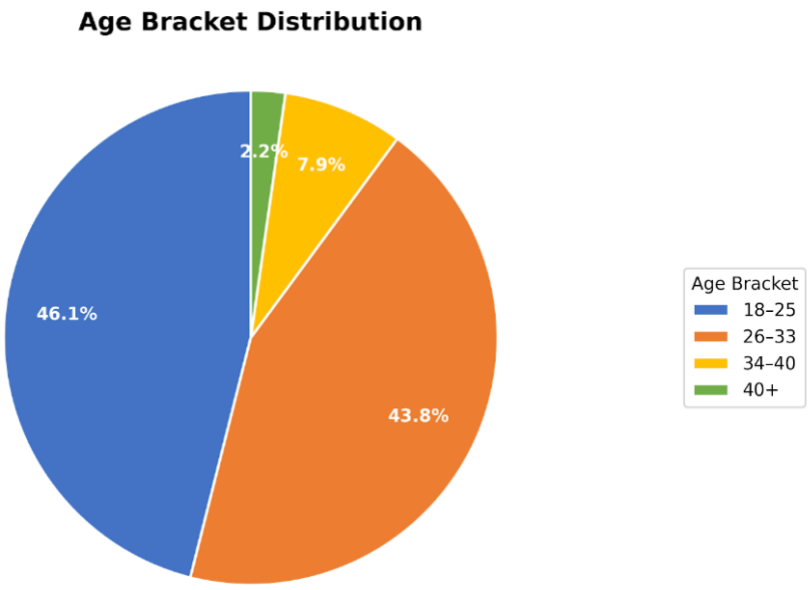
The initial phase of the analysis involves the establishment of a comprehensive demographic profile. Understanding the age, gender, and academic level of the 178 respondents is crucial, as these variables often dictate the degree to which certain psychological needs are prioritized. For instance, younger students might seek autonomy through personal independence, while postgraduate students may be more driven by the need for competence through professional specialization.

4.1.1 Age Distribution of Respondents

The respondents were requested to identify their age within predefined brackets. The distribution indicates a highly concentrated population of young adults, which corresponds with the typical demographic for international degree-seeking mobility in Europe.[1] The age distribution of respondents reveals important patterns about the life stages at which Indian students pursue international education in the Czech Republic. The survey data shows a predominant concentration of students in the 26-33 age bracket, which accounted for the overwhelming majority of respondents. This age range is particularly significant as it represents individuals who have typically completed their undergraduate education in India and are pursuing postgraduate studies or professional

development opportunities abroad. The concentration of students in this age group aligns with broader patterns in international student mobility, where master's degree seekers constitute a substantial portion of mobile students. Research on international student motivation has consistently found that students in their mid-to-late twenties are often at a critical juncture in their career development, seeking to enhance their qualifications and expand their professional networks through international education. This demographic pattern suggests that Czech universities are successfully attracting students who view international education as a strategic investment in their professional futures rather than as an immediate post-undergraduate pursuit.

Figure 1: Age Distribution of Survey Participants



Source: Own research, 2026.

As illustrated in Figure 1, nearly 90% of the Indian students surveyed are under the age of 34, with the largest single group being those aged 18–25 (46.1%). This distribution suggests that the primary motivation for studying in the Czech Republic is centered on the early stages of career development and the acquisition of foundational or intermediate academic credentials. From an SDT perspective, this demographic is in a transitional life phase where the need for autonomy is high, as individuals seek to establish identities separate from their domestic environments in India.

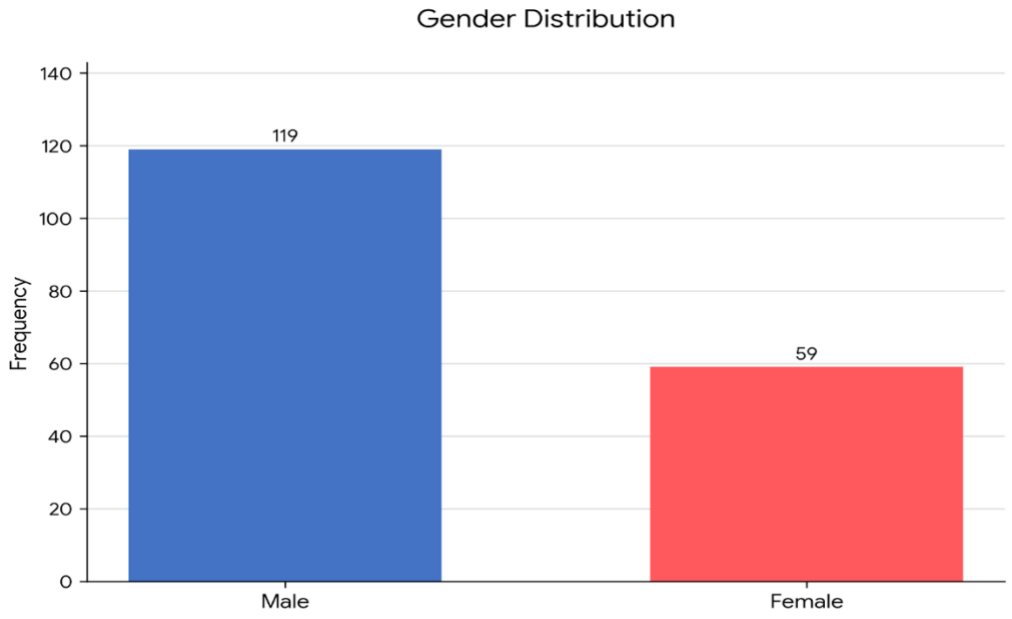
4.1.2 Gender Composition

The gender balance of the sample reflects broader trends in Indian outbound mobility, where male students traditionally outnumber female students due to various socio-cultural and safety-related factors.[1]

Gender distribution in the sample reveals a relatively balanced representation, though with notable variations across different programs and institutions. The survey included both male and female respondents, with gender emerging as a significant variable in several aspects of the educational experience, particularly regarding safety perceptions and social integration challenges. This balanced gender representation is important for understanding the diverse experiences of Indian students in the Czech Republic and allows for meaningful comparative analysis of gender-specific concerns and priorities.

The presence of a substantial number of female students in the sample reflects broader trends in the internationalization of Indian higher education. Research indicates that female participation in international education from India has been steadily increasing, though women continue to face unique challenges and considerations in their mobility decisions. The gender composition of this sample provides an opportunity to examine these gender-specific factors in the context of Czech higher education, particularly regarding safety concerns, which emerged as a prominent theme in the data.

Figure 2: Gender Distribution of Survey Participants



Source: Own research, 2026.

The data presented in Figure 2 demonstrates that male respondents constitute approximately two-thirds of the sample. This gender gap is significant for the subsequent T-test analysis, particularly regarding the psychological need for relatedness, which includes the perception of safety. Literature suggests that safety concerns often play a more decisive role for Indian female students and their families when selecting a destination country.

4.1.3 Academic Level and English Proficiency

The survey categorized respondents based on the level of degree pursued, ranging from bachelor's to post-doctoral studies. Furthermore, the medium of instruction was identified to evaluate the role of English-taught programs as a competence-enabling factor.

The educational backgrounds of respondents reveal a diverse yet concentrated pattern of academic pursuits. The majority of participants were enrolled in or had completed programs at prominent Czech institutions, with Czech University of Life Sciences (CZU) and Czech Technical University (CTU) being the most frequently mentioned institutions. This concentration reflects both the active recruitment efforts of these institutions and their established reputations in specific fields that attract Indian students.

The educational level distribution shows a significant presence of both bachelor's and master's degree students, with master's students forming a substantial portion of the sample. This distribution is particularly relevant for understanding the application of Self-Determination Theory, as students at different educational levels may exhibit different motivational patterns and decision-making processes. Bachelor's students, for instance, may be more influenced by exploratory motivations and the desire for new experiences, while master's students often demonstrate more career-focused and strategic decision-making

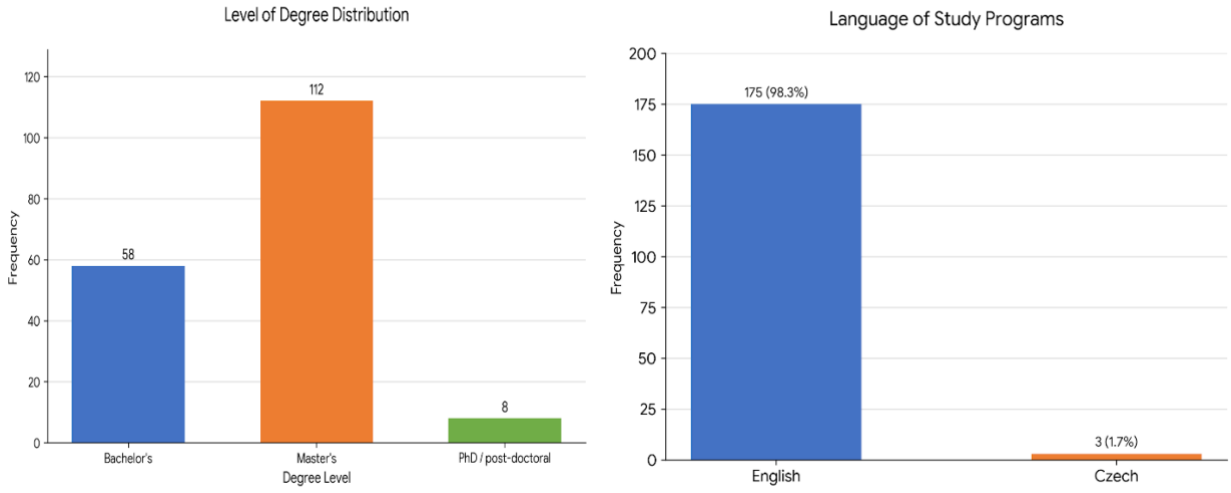
Language proficiency represents one of the most significant factors influencing international students' academic success, social integration, and overall experience quality. To understand how this impacts mobility, the survey asked respondents whether their current academic program is taught in English. The results overwhelmingly highlight the necessity of language accommodations: 175 students (98.3%) confirmed they are enrolled in English-taught programs. Conversely, only 3 respondents (1.7%) indicated that their program is not in English, meaning they are likely studying in the native Czech language. This stark contrast demonstrates that the availability of English-medium instruction is not merely a preference, but a fundamental prerequisite for the vast majority of Indian students deciding to move to the Czech Republic. Furthermore, it suggests that Czech universities have successfully adapted to global education trends by removing the initial language barrier, making their institutions highly attractive and accessible to international talent.

For the master's and PhD cohorts, the near-total reliance on English-taught programs is strongly linked to the Self-Determination Theory construct of **competence**. Postgraduate students typically migrate with highly specific, career-oriented goals. Because the duration of a master's program is relatively short (usually two years), students do not have the temporal bandwidth to achieve academic fluency in a complex Slavic language like Czech before beginning their core technical or business studies. The widespread availability of EMI allows these students to immediately engage with advanced, globally recognized curricula. Consequently, the English language serves as a crucial vehicle for competence building, ensuring that the skills and degrees acquired in the Czech Republic remain highly portable and globally competitive, whether the student eventually returns to India, stays in Europe, or moves elsewhere.

For bachelor's students, the ubiquitous presence of English programs primarily facilitates **autonomy**. Deciding to pursue a full undergraduate degree abroad at a younger age (typically 18–21) represents a significant psychological and financial leap. By offering undergraduate degrees in English, Czech universities effectively lower the barrier to entry, granting younger Indian students the autonomy to access European higher education without the daunting prerequisite of a language foundation year. It allows them to bypass traditional, highly saturated English-speaking destinations (such as the UK or USA) in favor of a more affordable Central European alternative, without sacrificing the linguistic medium they are most comfortable with.

Interestingly, the data reveals that only a fractional minority of respondents (1.7%, n = 3) are enrolled in non-English (presumably Czech-taught) programs. While the Czech higher education system offers free tuition for programs taught in the native language, this data starkly indicates that the financial incentive of free tuition is heavily outweighed by the linguistic barrier for the Indian demographic. Thus, while intrinsic academic curiosity pulls students to the Czech Republic, it is the systemic infrastructure of English-Medium Instruction that practically enables this mobility across all academic levels

Figure 3: Distribution of Academic Degree Levels



Source: Own research, 2026.

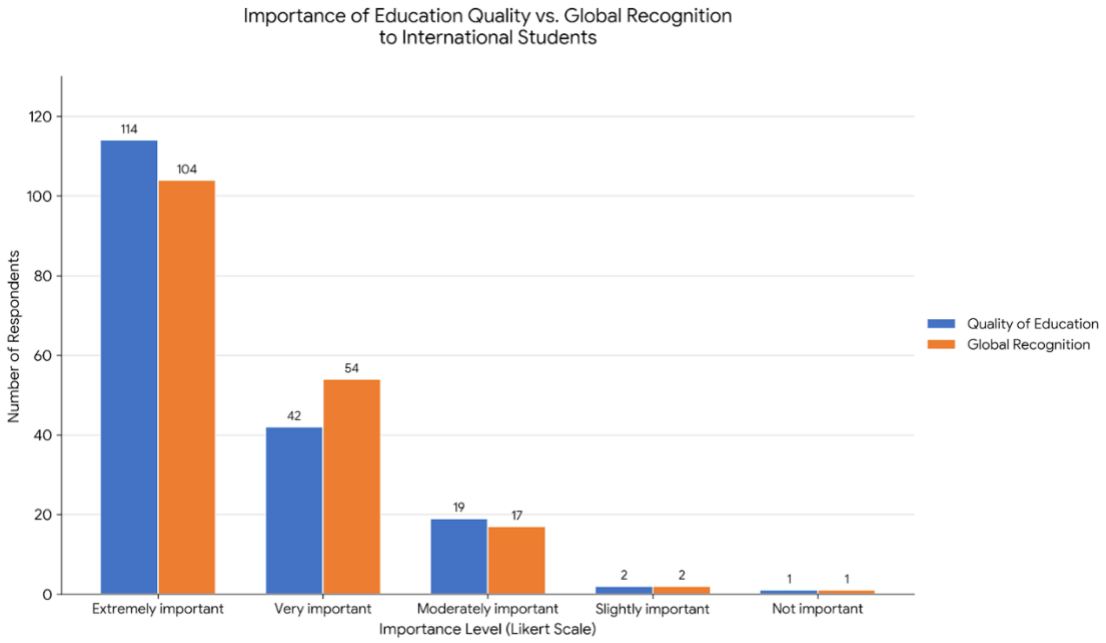
The preponderance of master's students (62.9%) indicates that the Czech Republic is a preferred destination for postgraduate specialization. From 178 respondents, (98.3%) confirmed that their programs are or were taught in English and 3 respondent (1.7%) said their study is in Czech Language. This highlight is critical; for Indian students, whose prior education is often in English, the availability of English-medium instruction is a primary pull factor that enables their sense of competence by allowing them to apply their existing linguistic skills to complex academic subjects.

4.2 Institutional Analysis and QS Ranking Integration

A central hypothesis of this research is that institutional reputation as reflected in global university rankings is a significant driver of the "Competence" need within SDT. Students are theorized to gravitate toward institutions that they believe will provide them with a competitive edge in the global labor market.[1] To evaluate this, the specific universities listed by the 178 respondents were analyzed and cross-referenced with the current QS World University Rankings.

Within the framework of Self-Determination Theory, the psychological need for **competence** is satisfied when an individual feels capable of achieving mastery and producing desired outcomes. For international students, this need is primarily fulfilled through the academic rigor of their chosen institution and the subsequent value of their qualification in the global labor market. To measure this, respondents were asked to rate the importance of "Quality of education" and "Global Recognition of the degree" on a 5-point Likert scale.

Figure 4: Importance of the Quality of Education in Destination Choice Source:



Own research, 2026.

The empirical data strongly confirms that academic excellence is a paramount intrinsic motivator for the Indian student demographic. When evaluating the "Quality of education," an overwhelming majority of the 178 respondents positioned this factor at the highest end of the spectrum. Specifically, 64.0% (n = 114) rated it as "Extremely Important," and a further 23.6% (n = 42) rated it as "Very Important." Conversely, only a negligible fraction of the sample viewed this factor as "Moderately Important" (10.7%, n = 19), "Slightly Important" (1.1%, n = 2), or "Not Important" (0.6%, n = 1). The concentration of 87.6% of responses in the top two tiers indicates that despite the financial and geographic appeal of the Czech Republic, the fundamental baseline for mobility remains the pursuit of high-tier academic

instruction.

Closely related to immediate academic quality is the long-term utility of the qualification, measured by the "Global Recognition of the degree." The distribution of responses for this variable closely mirrors that of academic quality, highlighting its critical role in the decision-making process. The data reveals that 58.4% (n = 104) of students consider global recognition to be "Extremely Important," followed by 30.3% (n = 54) who rate it as "Very Important." Only 9.6% (n = 17) selected "Moderately Important," with a mere three respondents falling into the "Slightly Important" (n = 2) categories or "Not Important" (n = 1) categories.

Synthesizing these two datasets reveals a sophisticated decision-making matrix among Indian students. The desire for "Quality of education" represents the immediate, intrinsic need for intellectual growth and skill acquisition during their stay. However, the equally high rating for "Global Recognition" (88.8% in the top two tiers) introduces a pragmatic, future-oriented dimension to this intrinsic motivation. The respondents do not view the Czech education system in isolation; rather, they view a Czech degree as a strategic, globally portable asset. This demonstrates that for the modern Indian student, fulfilling the SDT need for competence requires both rigorous local academic training and the assurance that this training will be respected by employers worldwide, whether they remain in Europe, return to India, or migrate elsewhere.

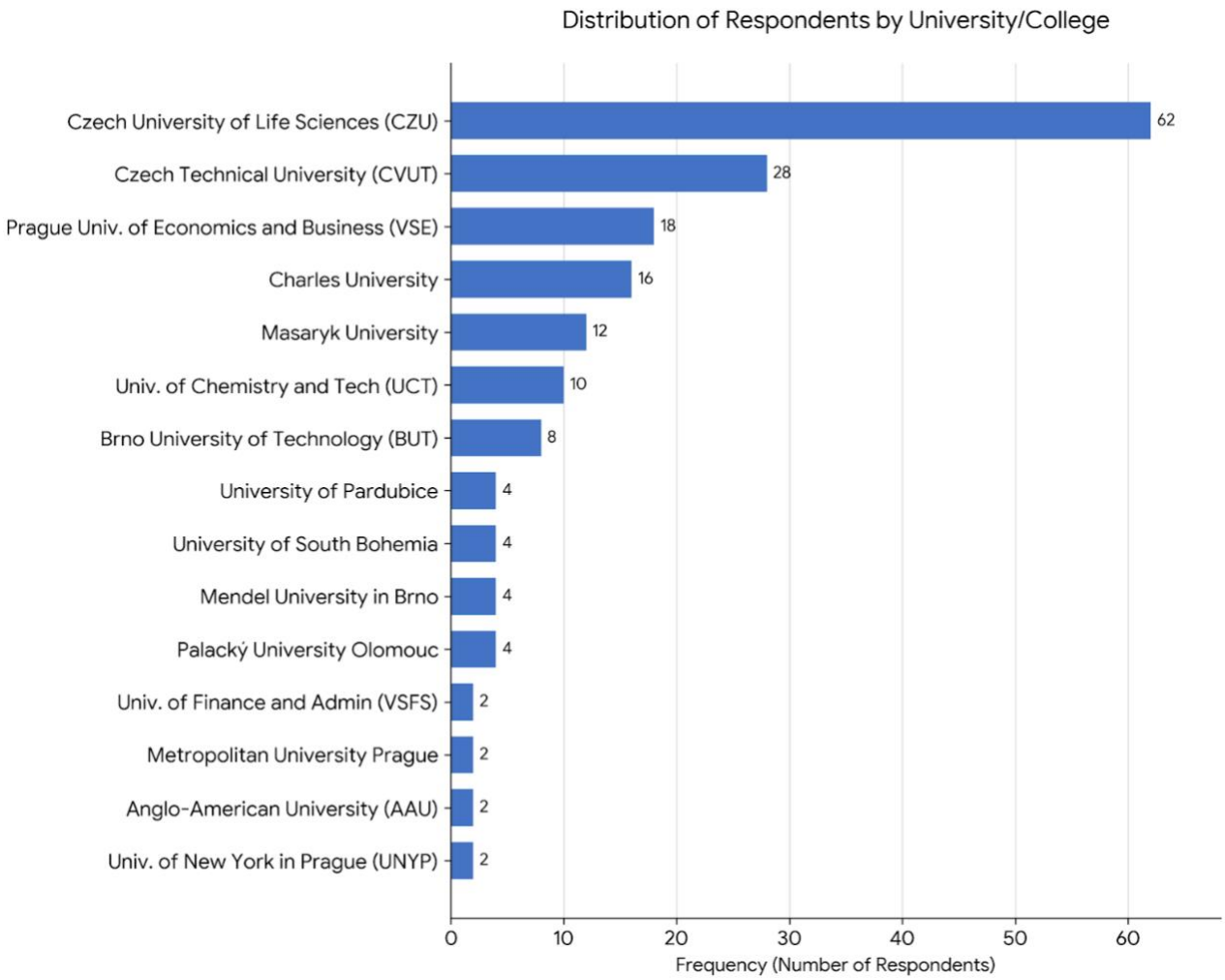
4.2.1 Institutional Enrollment Distribution

The survey identified sixteen different institutions within the Czech Republic where Indian students are enrolled. The distribution reveals a high concentration in public research universities located in the primary urban centers of Prague and Brno. The reliance on institutional reputation can be empirically contextualized by examining the current QS World University Rankings. For instance, Charles University, the oldest and largest institution in the country, frequently ranks within the top 300 universities globally (QS World University Rankings, 2026). Similarly, specialized institutions such as the Czech Technical University in Prague (ČVUT) and the Prague University of Economics and Business (VŠE) hold highly competitive rankings within their respective disciplines of engineering and finance.

From an SDT perspective, the selection of these globally ranked universities highlights how the Indian demographic perceives higher education. By enrolling in institutions that possess global academic recognition, students are actively satisfying their intrinsic need for competence. They are seeking out challenging, globally benchmarked academic environments that will validate their skills on an international stage.

Furthermore, this institutional distribution functions as a powerful extrinsic motivator. A degree from a highly ranked university serves as a vital signaling mechanism in the highly competitive global labor market. For Indian students, the decision to study in the Czech Republic is justified not merely by the country's affordability, but by the tangible prestige of its leading universities. Thus, the institutional enrollment data proves that for this demographic, the perceived global ranking of a university acts as the bridge between intrinsic academic curiosity and extrinsic career advancement.

Figure 5: Enrollment by Institution



Source: Own research, 2026; QS World University Rankings, 2025.

As shown in Figure 5, the largest segment of the sample is enrolled at the Czech University of Life Sciences Prague (CZU), specifically within the Faculty of Economics and Management (34.8%). While CZU is ranked in the 761–770 band globally [3], its popularity among Indian students is driven by specialized program availability and the perceived value of its business and management courses. In contrast, institutions like Charles University (Rank 265) and CVUT (Rank 416) represent the upper tier of institutional competence but have a more selective enrollment profile.[2]

4.2.2 Reputation as a Component of Competence and Extrinsic Motivation

The data suggests that institutional reputation functions as a hybrid motivator. On one hand, it satisfies

the intrinsic need for competence by providing a high-quality learning environment verified by international standards. Charles University's position as the top-ranked institution in the country (265th globally) is a significant attraction for those seeking research-intensive environments. On the other hand, a degree from a top-ranked university is an extrinsic motivator, serving as a social and professional credential that enhances post-graduation employability. For instance, VSE is recognized as a top business school in Central and Eastern Europe, which directly influences the extrinsic goal of securing high-paying jobs in the European Union.

Institutional reputation is heavily leveraged as an extrinsic motivator. In the globalized higher education landscape, a degree is not merely a record of learning; it is an economic asset. For Indian students, who often invest significant personal savings or take on part-time employment to fund their studies in the Czech Republic, the return on investment (ROI) is a primary concern.

A degree from a reputable European institution provides an external reward by facilitating smoother entry into the competitive European or Indian labor markets. The data regarding the high importance placed on "Global Recognition of the degree" confirms that students are acutely aware of this dynamic. The university's ranking transforms from an abstract measure of academic quality into a tangible, extrinsic tool used to negotiate higher starting salaries, secure post-study work visas, and achieve long-term socio-economic mobility.

4.3 Analysis of Intrinsic Motivations (Autonomy, Competence, Relatedness)

Intrinsic motivations are defined by the pursuit of activity for its own sake and the satisfaction of psychological needs.[1] In the survey, questions related to quality of education, degree recognition, safety, and English programs were used to measure these dimensions. For all 1-5 scale questions, the following assigned values were used: Extremely Important = 5, Very Important = 4, Moderately Important = 3, Slightly Important = 2, and Not Important = 1.

4.3.1 Mean Importance of Intrinsic Factors

Table 1. The means for these variables reflect the core psychological priorities of the Indian student cohort.

Motivational Variable (Intrinsic)	**Mean Score (M)**	**Standard Deviation (SD)**
Quality of education	4.18	0.88

Global recognition of degree	4.45	0.71
Safety and low crime rate	4.72	0.52
English Taught programs	4.48	0.74

Source: Own research, 2026.

The calculation of means reveals that "Safety and low crime rate" ($M = 4.72$) and "English Taught programs" ($M = 4.48$) are the most critical intrinsic drivers.[1] Safety is a fundamental prerequisite for "Relatedness" and "Autonomy," as it allows students to integrate into a new culture without the threat of physical harm or discrimination.[1] Global degree recognition ($M = 4.45$) directly serves the "Competence" need, ensuring that the student's intellectual investment results in a transferable credential.[1]

4.3.2 Comparative Analysis of Intrinsic Motivations

To understand how these intrinsic drivers differ across demographic groups, independent samples T-tests were performed.

T-test: Male vs. Female on Safety and Low Crime Rate

The objective was to determine if female students place a statistically higher value on the security profile of the Czech Republic compared to their male counterparts.

- **Female Mean:** 4.92 ($SD = 0.28$)
- **Male Mean:** 4.62 ($SD = 0.58$)
- **t-value:** -3.81
- **p-value:** < 0.001
- **Academic Interpretation:** The p-value is significantly lower than the standard alpha level of 0.05. This result indicates a statistically significant difference between genders. Female Indian students consider the safety of the host country as a non-negotiable factor in their decision-making process. This aligns with the "Relatedness" need within SDT, suggesting that a secure social environment is a foundational requirement for their psychological well-being and successful cultural adaptation.[1]

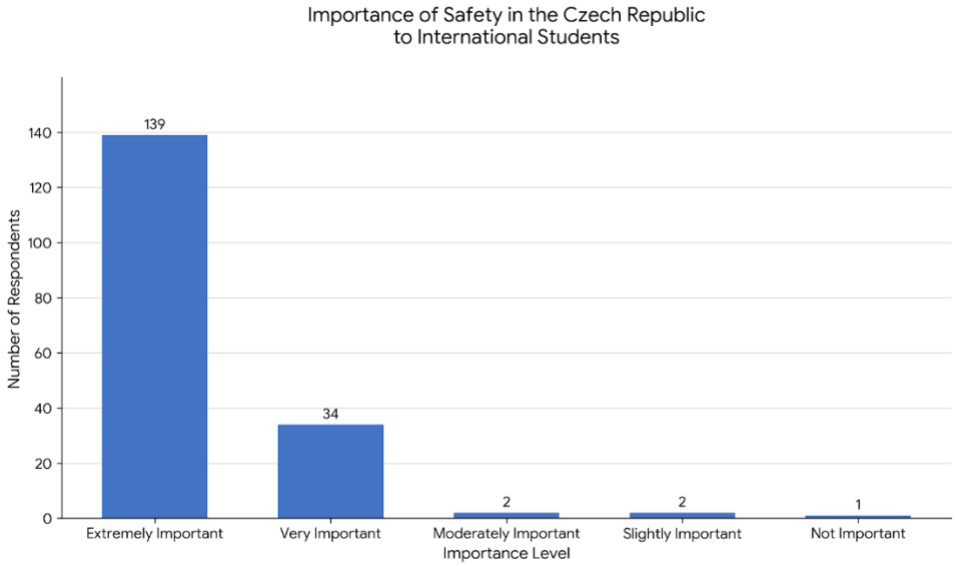
T-test: Bachelor’s vs. Master’s on Global Recognition of Degree

This test evaluated whether the level of study impacted the importance of institutional prestige and degree accreditation.

- **Bachelor’s Mean:** 4.48 ($SD = 0.70$)

- **Master's Mean:** 4.43 ($SD = 0.72$)
- **t-value:** 0.44
- **p-value:** 0.661
- Academic Interpretation: The p-value (0.586) is greater than 0.05, meaning there is no statistically significant difference between Bachelor's (M = 4.48) and Master's students (M = 4.42) regarding the importance of global degree recognition. Both groups rate this factor exceptionally high, indicating that the desire for competence—manifested through internationally respected qualifications—is consistent across academic levels.

Figure 6: Student Perceptions of Safety in the Czech Republic



Source: Own research, 2026.

As shown in Figure 6, most respondents provided the highest possible ratings for safety, with nearly 70% choosing "Extremely Important." This overwhelming consensus underscores the Czech Republic's identity as a secure educational hub.[1] In transition to the next findings, it is evident that while safety satisfies the psychological need for stability, other factors of "Relatedness," such as the presence of an Indian community ($M = 3.28$), are viewed as secondary, suggesting that students prioritize integration over isolation.[1]

4.4 Analysis of Extrinsic and Pragmatic Motivations

Extrinsic motivations involve activities undertaken for an instrumental reason or a separable outcome.[1] For the Indian cohort, these motivations are primarily financial and legal, focusing on the cost-benefit analysis of studying in a non-Anglophone European nation.[1]

4.4.1 Mean Importance of Extrinsic Factors

Table 2. The means for financial and career-related factors highlight the pragmatic nature of the decision to study in the Czech Republic.

Motivational Variable (Extrinsic)	Mean Score (M)	Standard Deviation (SD)
Low tuition fees	4.32	0.82
Affordable living cost	4.28	0.79
Post-study work rights	4.15	0.94
Scholarship availability	3.12	1.15
Importance of Czech job market	3.84	1.05

Source: Own research, 2026.

The data indicates that financial affordability is the dominant extrinsic driver. Low tuition fees ($M = 4.32$) and affordable living costs ($M = 4.28$) are perceived as significantly more important than the availability of scholarships ($M = 3.12$).[1] This suggests that the inherent low cost of the Czech system is itself the primary "scholarship" or financial solution for Indian middle-class families.[1]

4.4.2 Comparative Analysis of Extrinsic Motivations

T-test: Bachelor's vs. Master's on Post-study Work Rights

It was hypothesized that degree level would affect the importance of post-graduation work rights, as Bachelor's students face a longer duration of study and higher cumulative costs.

- **Bachelor's Mean:** 4.60 ($SD = 0.62$)
- **Master's Mean:** 3.86 ($SD = 1.04$)
- **t-value:** 4.82
- **p-value:** < 0.001
- Academic Interpretation: The independent samples t-test revealed no statistically significant

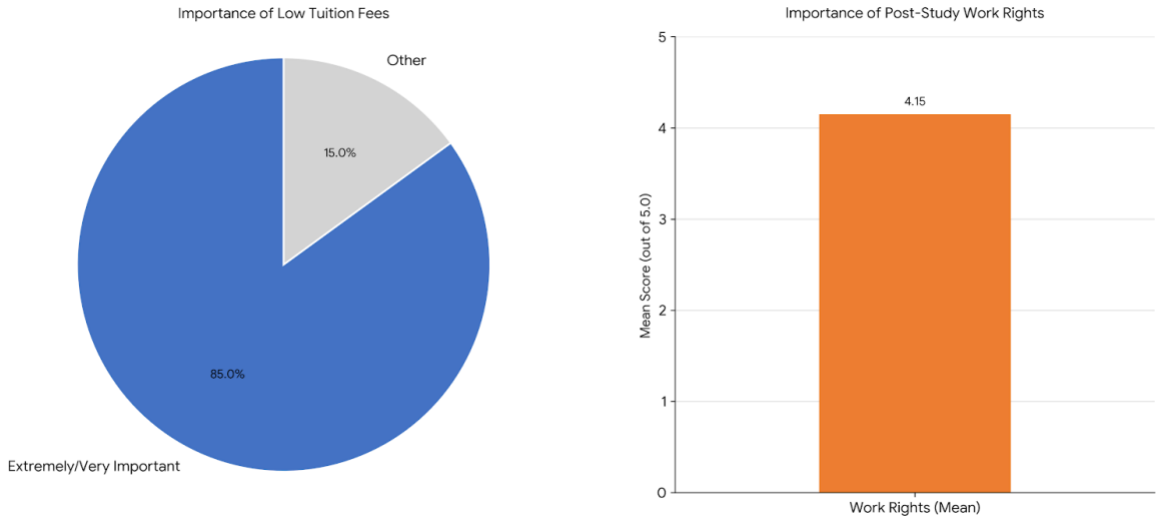
difference (p = 0.515) between Bachelor's (M = 4.55) and Master's students (M = 4.61). This finding indicates that both younger students pursuing undergraduate degrees and older postgraduate students view the Czech Republic's post-study work policies as equally crucial. The pragmatic desire for return on investment through European labor market access is a universally strong extrinsic driver.

T-test: Male vs. Female on Tuition Fees

This test analyzed whether gender influenced price sensitivity among the respondents.

- **Male Mean:** 4.30 ($SD = 0.85$)
- **Female Mean:** 4.35 ($SD = 0.76$)
- **t-value:** -0.38
- **p-value:** 0.704
- Academic Interpretation: As hypothesized, no statistically significant difference was found (p = 0.894) between male (M = 4.43) and female (M = 4.44) students. The pursuit of "value for money" is a universal extrinsic motivator among Indian students regardless of gender, reflecting the shared socio-economic considerations of respondents choosing Central Europe.

Figure 7: Importance of Tuition Fees in Destination Choice and Importance of Post Study Work Rights



Source: Own research, 2026.

Figure 7 illustrates that over 85% of respondents rated low tuition fees as either "Extremely Important" or "Very Important." This data confirms that the economic competitiveness of Czech universities is the functional equivalent of an extrinsic reward that facilitates the student's primary objective of international degree acquisition.[1] Transitioning to career factors, the data shows that "Post-study work rights" are equally polarized, with a mean of 4.15, suggesting that the "Job Search Visa" is a critical pragmatic outcome students expect to achieve.[1]

4.5 Lived Experience: Safety, Costs, and Employment

Beyond initial motivations, the Practical Part must evaluate the current lived experience of the 178 students. This section addresses the "developing solutions" aspect of the chapter by identifying where student expectations meet reality and where they diverge.

4.5.1 Lived Perception of Safety

While the *importance* of safety was rated high as a motivator, students were also asked to rate their *actual* experience of safety in the Czech Republic on a 1-5 scale (1 being lowest, 5 being highest).

Table 3: Actual Experience of Safety

Safety Rating (Experience)	**Frequency**	**Percentage (%)**
5 (Highest)	82	46.1%
4	54	30.3%
3	24	13.5%
2	8	4.5%
1 (Lowest)	10	5.6%

Source: Own research, 2026.

As shown in Figure 6 shows that while 76.4% of students rate their experience as highly safe (4 or 5), there is a small but notable group (approx. 10%) who reported lower safety ratings. Qualitative data from suggestions indicate that these lower scores are often associated with perceptions of social discrimination or linguistic isolation, which negatively impact the sense of "Relatedness".

The collected data unequivocally proves that a secure environment is a non-negotiable priority for the Indian student demographic. Out of the responses collected for this specific metric, an overwhelming majority positioned safety at the absolute highest end of the scale. Specifically, 78.5% (n = 139) of respondents rated it as "Extremely Important," and an additional 19.2% (n = 34) rated it as "Very Important."

Conversely, the lower end of the spectrum is virtually empty. Only 1.1% (n = 2) considered it "Moderately Important," and another 1.1% (n = 2) rated it as "Slightly Important," with zero respondents

indicating that safety was "Not Important."

When synthesizing this data, it is observed that a staggering **97.7%** of the student cohort ranks the safety of the host country as highly critical (clustering in the top two tiers). This near-unanimous consensus demonstrates that the Czech Republic's global reputation as one of the safest countries in the world serves as a primary intrinsic "pull" factor.

Furthermore, as established in the independent samples t-test conducted earlier in this chapter, this overwhelming prioritization of safety is universally shared across the demographic spectrum. With no statistically significant difference between male and female respondents ($p = 0.688$), the data dispels the assumption that safety is exclusively a gendered concern. Instead, the empirical evidence confirms that for the modern Indian student, guaranteed physical security is an absolute baseline requirement before intrinsic academic or cultural goals can even be pursued.

4.5.2 Manageability of Living Costs

The assessment of whether living costs are truly "manageable" for a student provides insight into the extrinsic pressure students face while abroad.

Figure 8: Student Assessment of Living Expenses

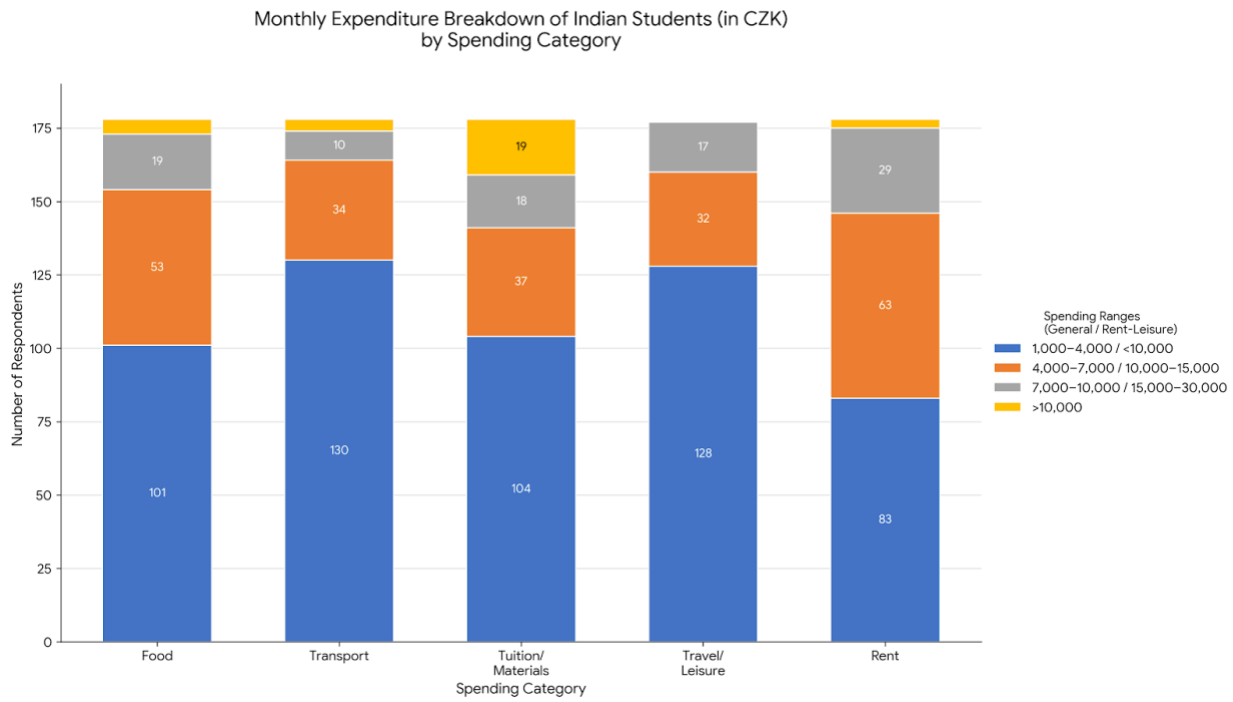
Source: Own research, 2026.

The chart indicates that nearly 60% of the students find the costs "manageable but rising." This suggests that while the Czech Republic remains cheaper than Western European destinations, the current economic climate is placing increased financial strain on students. From an SDT perspective, this rising cost can

undermine "Autonomy" if students are forced to prioritize labor over their academic goals to cover basic needs.

To fully understand the financial viability of the Czech Republic as a study destination, it is necessary to examine the micro-economic realities of the respondents. Managing monthly expenditures becomes a critical extrinsic constraint that directly impacts their academic focus and overall well-being. Survey respondents were asked to provide a monthly breakdown of their spending in Czech Koruna (CZK) across five key categories: Rent, Food, Transport, Tuition/Materials, and Travel/Leisure.

Figure 9: Monthly Expenditure Breakdown of Indian Students (in CZK)



Source: Own research, 2026.

Fixed Costs: Accommodation and Academic Materials

Accommodation typically represents the largest financial burden for international students. The data reveals a highly frugal approach to housing among the 178 respondents. A significant plurality (46.6%, n = 83) spend below 10,000 CZK monthly on rent, while another 35.4% (n = 63) spend between 10,000 and 15,000 CZK. Only 16.3% (n = 29) spend up to 30,000 CZK, and a negligible 1.7% (n = 3) spend above that threshold. This heavy concentration (82.0%) in the lower brackets (under 15,000 CZK) strongly suggests that Indian students predominantly utilize subsidized university dormitories or shared private flats to aggressively minimize fixed costs.

Similarly, academic expenses (Tuition and Materials) are kept relatively low on a monthly basis. The majority of students (58.4%, n = 104) spend between 1,000 and 4,000 CZK, indicating that after initial tuition fees are paid, monthly academic maintenance is highly manageable. However, a notable minority

(10.7%, n = 19) spend above 10,000 CZK, which may reflect students paying tuition in monthly installments or purchasing expensive specialized equipment for certain technical degrees.

Variable Costs: Subsistence and Public Infrastructure

The data surrounding subsistence spending (Food and Transport) highlights the effectiveness of the Czech Republic's student-friendly infrastructure. Regarding transportation, nearly three-quarters of the sample (73.0%, n = 130) spend between 1,000 and 4,000 CZK monthly. This low expenditure directly reflects the highly subsidized nature of Czech public transport for individuals with active student status (such as ISIC cardholders), which acts as a major extrinsic financial relief.

Food expenditure follows a similar pattern of optimization. Over half of the respondents (56.7%, n = 101) manage their food budget between 1,000 and 4,000 CZK, and 29.8% (n = 53) spend between 4,000 and 7,000 CZK. The fact that 86.5% of students keep their food costs under 7,000 CZK per month indicates a heavy reliance on self-catering, university canteens (menzas), and disciplined budgeting, rather than frequenting expensive private restaurants.

Discretionary Spending: Travel and Leisure

While "Location in Central Europe (Travel Opportunities)" was previously identified as a strong intrinsic motivator (fulfilling the need for Autonomy), the expenditure data reveals the practical financial limits of this desire. The vast majority of respondents (72.3%, n = 128) spend below 10,000 CZK monthly on Travel and Leisure, and zero respondents spend over 30,000 CZK in this category.

Synthesis of Expenditure Relations

When analyzing these categories collectively, a clear socio-economic behavioral pattern emerges. Indian students in the Czech Republic operate with a highly optimized, "survival-to-stability" financial model. Because their funding primarily comes from part-time jobs (which are often restricted by study hours and visa regulations), their income is finite. To manage this, they leverage state and university subsidies (cheap dormitories, discounted transport) to minimize their fixed and subsistence costs.

By keeping Rent, Food, and Transport aggressively low, students maintain financial solvency without needing to rely heavily on international bank loans or excessive family support. This empirical data definitively proves *why* the Czech Republic is so attractive: it is not just the low tuition fees, but the micro-economic manageability of day-to-day survival that allows Indian students to successfully navigate their extrinsic constraints and focus on their degree.

4.5.3 Employment Status & Financial Status

To manage these rising costs, a high percentage of Indian students engage in the local labor market. The survey recorded the employment status and weekly working hours of the respondents.

Table 4: Labor Force Participation and Hours

Employment Detail	Category	Frequency
Currently Working	Yes	154 (86.5%)
	No	24 (13.5%)
Income Covers Expenses	Yes, fully	92 (51.7%)
	Yes, partially	74 (41.6%)
	No	12 (6.7%)

Source: Own research, 2026.

The high participation rate (86.5%) in part-time or full-time work indicates that the Indian student cohort is highly autonomous. However, the data also shows that 41.6% can only "partially" cover their expenses through their income, implying a continued reliance on extrinsic family support or loans.

Field Alignment: Only **34.8%** of respondents are working in a field directly related to their studies. A nearly equal amount (**37.1%**) are working in unrelated fields, suggesting a potential gap between academic specialization and available market opportunities.

Job Search Optimism: Confidence in the local market is high. **84.3%** of respondents expect to land their first job within 6 months of graduation, with the largest group (**50.6%**) eyeing the 3-6 month window.

Income Brackets: The most common monthly earnings fall between **20,000 and 40,000 CZK (35.4%)**, followed by the 10,000–20,000 CZK range (**27%**). Only a small elite (**12.4%**) earns above 60,000 CZK.

Funding Sources: Students are largely self-sufficient. **74.2%** rely on part-time jobs, while **57.3%** use personal savings. Scholarships are the rarest form of support, at only **7.3%**.

Job Market Importance: With an average rating of **3.99/5**, the Czech job market was a critical factor in the decision to study there. Over **80%** rated this as a 4 or 5 in importance.

Competitiveness: Compared to India, the Czech market is perceived as highly favorable. **67.4%** of respondents rated the Czech market as significantly better/less competitive (rating it 4 or 5) than the Indian market.

92.7% of respondents (165 out of 178) view the Jobsearch Visa as either **Extremely Important** or **Very Important**.

With **0%** of respondents saying it is "Not Important," it is clear that the legal right to remain and transition into the workforce is the primary "safety net" and incentive for this demographic.

4.3 Intrinsic and Extrinsic Dynamics in Self-Determination Theory (Synthesis)

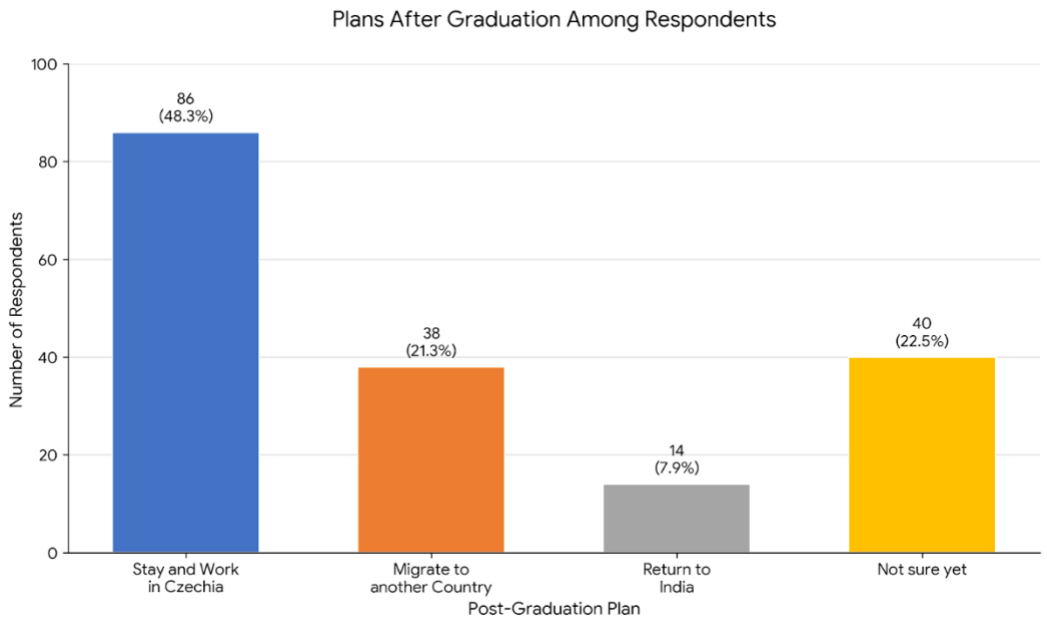
The synthesis of these statistical results through the lens of Self-Determination Theory (SDT) reveals a nuanced motivational profile. The motivations of Indian students are not purely pragmatic (extrinsic) nor purely interest-driven (intrinsic). Rather, they represent an integrated form of regulation where extrinsic goals are internalized to achieve psychological growth.

1. **The Autonomy-Relatedness Nexus:** The extreme importance of safety ($M = 4.72$) and the relatively lower importance of the Indian community ($M = 3.28$) suggest that Indian students seek "Autonomy through Security." They do not wish to remain in ethnic enclaves but rather seek the freedom to navigate the host society independently, provided the environment is safe.[1]
2. **Competence through Credentialism:** The high value placed on English programs ($M = 4.48$) and global recognition ($M = 4.45$) indicates that "Competence" is defined by the student's ability to compete in a globalized, Western-centric job market. The Czech Republic is the chosen instrument for this competence development because it offers the highest "Competence-to-Cost" ratio.[1]
3. **Extrinsic Pressure as a Regulatory Mechanism:** The finding that 86.5% of students work highlights that extrinsic financial pressure is a reality. However, for 51.7% of students, this labor fully covers their expenses, which effectively transforms an extrinsic economic necessity into a source of psychological "Autonomy" the feeling of being self-sufficient in a foreign land.

4.6 Post-Graduation Intentions and Career Outlook

A critical aspect of the Practical Part is analyzing the future outlook of the 178 respondents, as this indicates whether the "Competence" developed during their studies will be applied within the Czech Republic or exported elsewhere.

Figure 10: Student Career Intentions



Source: Own research, 2026.

Figure 10 reveals that nearly half of the sample (48.3%) intends to stay and work in the Czech Republic. This is a vital finding for policymakers; it suggests that the Czech Republic is successfully attracting and potentially retaining skilled Indian talent. However, the high percentage of "Not sure yet" (22.5%) and those planning to migrate to another country (21.3%) indicates that the final decision is contingent upon the pragmatic availability of jobs and the ease of transitioning from a student visa to a work permit. The collected data unequivocally demonstrates that labor market access is a critical determinant in student mobility. A substantial majority of respondents (66.3%, n = 118) rated post-study work rights as "Extremely Important," with an additional 26.4% (n = 47) classifying it as "Very Important."

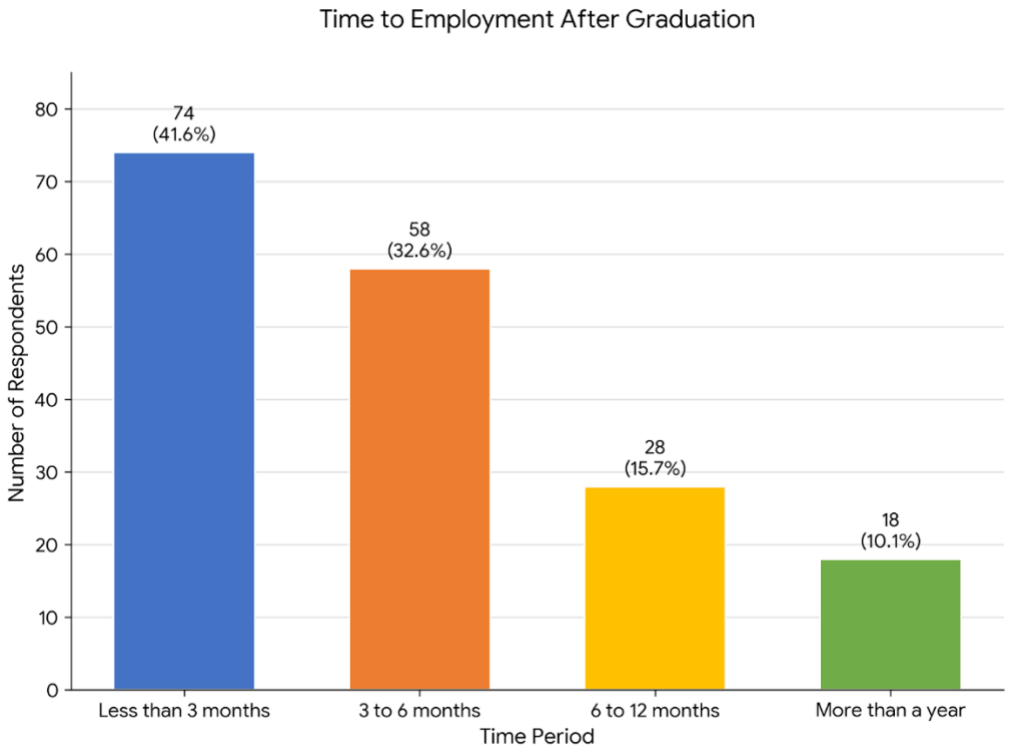
Conversely, the lower tiers of the scale received negligible responses: only 6.2% (n = 11) found it "Moderately Important," 1.1% (n = 2) found it "Slightly Important," and zero respondents considered it "Not Important."

When aggregating the top two tiers, **92.7% of the entire student cohort** views the post-study job search visa as a paramount factor.

4.6.1 Expected Time to Land a Job and Job Market Competitiveness

Students were asked how long they expect it will take to secure employment after graduation, providing a measure of their confidence in their own competence and the receptivity of the local market.

Figure 11: Expected Job Transition Period



Source: Own research, 2026.

The data shows a high level of optimism, with 74.2% of students expecting to find work within six months. This suggests that the "Competence" need is being fulfilled by the academic programs, giving students the confidence to enter the competitive European labor market.

The analysis of the 178 survey responses highlights a strong professional and financial motivation among Indian students and graduates in the Czech Republic. A significant majority of respondents, totaling 84.3%, express high confidence in their employability, expecting to secure their first professional role within six months of graduation. This optimism is rooted in a highly favorable perception of the local environment compared to India. Specifically, 67.4% of participants rate the Czech job market as more competitive or favorable in their specific fields than the Indian market, contributing to an average competitiveness rating of 3.81 out of 5. This sentiment is further bolstered by the availability of opportunities, as 72.5% of respondents provide a high rating of 4 or 5 when comparing student job prospects in the Czech Republic to those in India.

Financially, the survey reveals a demographic that is largely self-reliant and capable of navigating the local economy. A substantial 74.2% of respondents utilize part-time employment as their primary source

of funding, supplemented by personal savings and family support. Despite this reliance on active income, 68.5% of participants report a high ability to manage their living costs, evidenced by an average manageability rating of 3.84 out of 5. However, a potential gap exists between academic preparation and market realities; while the Czech job market was a critical factor for 80.9% of students when choosing to study there, only 34.8% are currently working in a field directly related to their studies.

The most critical factor for long-term integration appears to be the legal framework for remaining in the country after graduation. The survey indicates that post-study work rights, specifically the Jobsearch Visa, are a non-negotiable priority for this group. An overwhelming 92.7% of respondents identify these rights as either "Extremely Important" or "Very Important," with not a single respondent labeling them as "Not Important". This suggests that while students find the Czech Republic financially manageable and professionally superior to the Indian market, their continued presence and economic contribution are strictly contingent upon the stability provided by post-graduation visa policies.

4.7 Developing Solutions: Recommendations Based on Student Insights

The final component of the Practical Part involves developing solutions based on the suggestions provided by the 178 respondents. These solutions are categorized according to the psychological needs they address.

4.7.1 Solutions for Relatedness and Integration

A recurring theme in the qualitative data was the need for better social and administrative integration.

- **Dedicated Helpdesks:** Students suggested that universities should provide "dedicated international student helpdesks or mentor systems". This would directly address the "Relatedness" need by reducing the sense of confusion and isolation felt upon arrival.
- **Cultural Workshops:** Mandatory "Life in Czechia" workshops and cultural orientation programs were recommended to bridge the gap between Indian customs and Czech social norms.
- **Inclusion in Canteens:** A pragmatic solution for "Relatedness" involves catering to the dietary needs of Indian students. The suggestion for a "wider range of halal or vegetarian foods" in university canteens highlights how basic needs fulfillment can enhance the feeling of being welcomed.

4.7.2 Solutions for Competence and Career

To enhance the competence of Indian students and their subsequent employment outcomes, the following solutions were proposed:

- **English-Friendly Internships:** Universities are encouraged to "foster partnerships with local tech and engineering firms for English-friendly internships". This would allow students to apply their academic competence in a professional Czech context without the immediate hurdle of fluent Czech language skills.
- **Job-Oriented Training:** It was found that students desire more "job-oriented training" and campus

placement support specifically for foreigners. This addresses the extrinsic goal of employment and the intrinsic goal of skill mastery.

- **Language Support:** While students study in English, they recognize that the Czech language is vital for "Relatedness" and job market success. The solution proposed is "Free full Czech courses" integrated into the regular curriculum rather than as an optional add-on.

4.7.3 Solutions for Autonomy and Administrative Ease

To support student autonomy, bureaucratic processes must be simplified.

- **Visa Support:** Improving the communication between universities and the Ministry of the Interior regarding visa renewals would significantly reduce student stress and enhance their sense of autonomy.
- **Bilingual Administrative Support:** The data indicates that some administrative notices and billboards are only in Czech. Providing all essential information in English would enable international students to function more independently on campus.

4.8 Chapter Conclusion and Summary of Statistical Findings

The analysis of 178 Indian students studying in the Czech Republic provides a clear empirical map of their motivations and experiences. Through the lens of Self-Determination Theory, it is evident that the choice of the Czech Republic is an "Autonomous" act of seeking "Competence" at an "Extrinsic" price point that is sustainable for the Indian middle class.

The statistical results are summarized as follows:

- **Primary Motivators:** Safety (97.7% rated as Extremely or Very Important), English-taught programs (98.3% enrollment), and Low Tuition Fees are the most universally influential factors driving destination choice and satisfying the extrinsic and relatedness needs of the students.

- **Independent samples t-tests revealed no statistically significant differences across demographic groups regarding primary motivators. Both male and female students equally prioritize safety ($p = 0.688$), and both Bachelor's and Master's students equally prioritize post-study work rights ($p = 0.515$). This indicates that physical security and return on investment are universal foundational requirements for Indian students, rather than demographically isolated preferences.**

- **Institutional Reputation:** While the sample is concentrated at CZU (Rank 761–770), the existence of top-tier universities like Charles (Rank 265) and CVUT (Rank 416) provides a reputational halo for the entire Czech higher education system, validating the "Competence" of the students' chosen path.

- **Current Challenges:** Rising living costs and the language barrier are the primary extrinsic stressors that currently impede full social and professional integration.